



Quick Red-Flag Checklist

Print this page. Stick it near the phone. Ten seconds of checking beats ten months of recovery.

STOP AND VERIFY IF YOU SEE ANY OF THESE

- URGENCY - 'within 10 minutes', 'account will be blocked today', 'last chance'.
- SECRECY - 'do not tell anyone', 'this is a confidential defence matter'.
- OTP / PIN REQUEST - any request for OTP, UPI PIN, CVV, net-banking password.
- PAY TO RECEIVE - asked to send money, scan a QR or 'verify' to get money back.
- UNKNOWN LINKS - shortened links (bit.ly etc.), APK files, 'update KYC' links.
- TOO GOOD - guaranteed returns, lottery wins, jobs or plots at throwaway prices.
- AUTHORITY PRESSURE - fake police / CBI / army HQ officers, 'digital arrest' threats.
- IDENTITY PROPS - uniforms, ID cards, cantonment addresses used to build trust.
- CHANNEL SWITCH - pushed from the app or portal to WhatsApp / Telegram quickly.
- REFUSAL TO MEET - army buyer 'posted at border', can only pay in advance online.

THE 3-LINE DEFENCE

1. PAUSE - genuine organisations never rush you.
2. VERIFY - call back on the official number you find yourself, never the number given by the caller.
3. REPORT - 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in, even for attempts. Every report weakens the network.

Memory hook: 'OTP maanga? Matlab thug hai.' Anyone asking for an OTP is a thief - no exceptions.